

and support us. So that is on us to give the performances," said the Scotsman.

A victory against Hyderabad FC, who hadn't registered a win in 18 matches this season, in the next match would have added momentum for the playoff-chasing Chennaiyin. Instead, it's defeat reiterates Chennaiyin's woes in recent times.

Aashin Prasad

For the love of the game

Anwar Ali is the darling of the Mohun Bagan SG fans. The talented defender is greatly appreciated for his mental fortitude that sees the player overcoming physical adversities time and again. The thousands who had come to cheer the team recently when it hosted Jamshedpur FC in its home at Salt Lake Stadium were pleasantly surprised to see a giant tifo proclaiming Anwar as 'The Phoenix: Rising from ashes'.

The player was making a comeback after recovering from a hamstring problem sooner than expected. This happened in the first ISL derby of the season against East Bengal as the player limped off the ground after playing for just 13 minutes. Previously in the season Anwar was out of action for a considerable period of time due to an ankle injury, which also saw him miss the AFC Asian Cup.

It is his refusal to give in to difficulties and distress and bounce back strongly each time earlier than expected is what makes him the favourite of the fans. This underscores his resolve to play the game at the highest competitive level in the country despite being



diagnosed with a rare heart condition that almost threatened to end his career at its very inception.

It was that determination to overcome all odds that continues to drive the gifted defender, who has time and again upheld the saying by the famous American footballer Alex Karras "toughness is in the soul and spirit, not in the muscles."

Amitabha Das Sharma

Bengaluru blues

If there is one ISL fixture that is a sure-shot sellout at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium, it is the Bengaluru FC-Kerala Blasters contest. Men and women dressed in yellow come swarming into town

Overcoming adversity: Anwar Ali's (L) refusal to give in to difficulties and distress underscores his resolve to play the game at the highest competitive level despite being diagnosed with a rare heart condition that almost threatened to end his career. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

from the neighbouring state to support their beloved team. But for all their prayers and wishes, Blasters haven't ever won a game in Bengaluru. And it was the same yet again as BFC, which has struggled all-season to build a winning momentum, played the visitors off the park. To rub salt into the wounds, Blasters fans were also constantly reminded — through chants and banners — of the infamous walkout from last year when head coach Ivan Vukomanovic led the team off after a disagreement with the referee. According to Aristotle, a tragedy is generally accompanied by a change of fortune. Blasters are still waiting for it.

N. Sudarshan

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